

STATEMENT OF INTEREST

I am Mohammed Saed Sidibe and an International student from Ghana currently studying MEng Chemical Engineering.

I am writing to express my strong interest in leading the committee for newcomers and International students at the University of Calgary. With a deep passion for community building and extensive leadership experience, I believe I am well-positioned to support and empower new students as they transition into academic and social life in Canada.

My motivation stems from my personal journey and past leadership roles, particularly as vice president of the Fulani Youth Association of Ghana, a position I proudly held for four years. In this capacity, I collaborated with a diverse team to develop and implement initiatives that promoted cultural pride, educational advancement, and youth empowerment. We organized workshops, cultural events, and mentorship programs that not only celebrated our heritage but also addressed real-life challenges such as integration, identity, and access to opportunities. This role required strong organizational skills, empathy, and an ability to bridge cultural differences, all of which are critical in leading a committee that supports International students.

In addition to my community leadership, I also have valuable experience in managing large scale operations. I was responsible for overseeing a production crew of 80 technicians Volta Aluminium Company back in Ghana, a company where I honed my skills in team management, communication, conflict resolution, emotional intelligence and strategic planning. Managing such a large and diverse team taught me how to motivate individuals, coordinate complex tasks, and ensure the successful delivery of goals under pressure. I believe this operational experience will be instrumental in organizing events, workshops, and support systems for incoming students, ensuring that activities are both impactful and efficiently executed.

As someone who understands the complexities of adjusting to a new environment, I am passionate about making that process easier for others, and for this reason, I volunteered to be part of the University of Calgary's First-Generation Mentorship Program. I want to ensure that every International student and newcomer feels welcomed, valued, and supported from the moment they arrive. My vision for this committee includes creating a strong peer mentorship network, organizing orientation programs that go beyond academics, and fostering cross-cultural exchange that enriches the entire university community.

Furthermore, I am committed to inclusivity and collaboration. I understand that effective leadership is not about giving orders but about listening, facilitating, and empowering others. I plan to engage with stakeholders across campus including student services, cultural clubs, and other GSA committees, to create a unified support system for newcomers.

In conclusion, I bring a unique blend of community leadership, operational management, and a heartfelt commitment to inclusion and support. I am confident in my ability to lead this committee with empathy, diligence, and vision. I am excited about the opportunity to give back to the university community by helping International and newcomer students thrive at the University of Calgary, just as I have been supported in my journey.

